

CRACK THE CODE

Find a number's factorial that is closest to this page number. Subtract the answer to the first clue from this factorial-result.

Add 1, divide the result by 4 gives you the page to the next clue. Answer is the page number of your next clue. Go!

Hint: factorials: Factorial of 1 is 1, Factorial of 2 is 2, Factorial of 3 is 6...

Netbook test

Despite the small form factor, netbook manufacturers have realized the importance of the USB ports. Which is why, most netbooks have been packed in with three, except the designer netbook among them all! The Asus 1008P Karim Rashid edition, in the midst of all the style and colour attempts to get away with only two.

Performance

Some netbooks now have dual core processors, thanks to Intel's latest generation Atom N550 processor. What we witness in the shootout is that there are a variety of processors available in the netbooks. Intel Atom N270, N450, N455, N550 and N570 are spread across the models. Out of all these offerings from Intel, the N550 and the N570 Atom processors are the dual core type.

The Asus Eee PC 1018P is powered by Intel's Atom N550, clocking at 1.5 GHz with 2 GB DDR3 RAM @ 667 MHz. The Champion WBook got the lowest score 1375. This is because of the Atom N270 processor and 1GB DDR2 RAM @ 667MHz. AMD's only flag bearer, the Acer Aspire One clocked an impressive score of 1797 which puts it in a very strong midfield position, despite having a much slower clock speed (1 GHz), than the rivals.

Graphics performance has never been the strong point o

for netbooks. And we can see why, since none except one, has a dedicated graphics solution on offer. The Acer Aspire One 522 comes with the ATI Radeon HD6250 graphics, with 256 MB dedicated video RAM.



Asus Eee PC 1015PW

And it isn't surprising that this machine tops the score sheet of the 3D Mark 06 scores. The score of 167 puts it in pole position, but what is a surprise is that despite this, it isn't beating its rivals hands down. The HP Mini with a score of 159 and the Asus Karim Rashid netbook with a score of 156 run it close. However, if you want a netbook that you can connect to the flat panel television via HDMI, then the Acer Aspire One is the only option among all these.

Battery Life

Since netbooks put most of their eggs in the better battery life basket, it will be interesting to see how they fare here. Not only against each other, but how much advantage do they really have over the full-fledged

notebooks. The results were pretty disappointing.

The Acer Aspire One, the only AMD powered machine here, wins this battle hands down. The tested battery life of 3 hours and 24 minutes is leaps and bounds ahead of all competitors, with the 4400mAh battery. The second placed Asus 1015PW runs out of juice in 2 hours 42 minutes, despite having a significantly bigger 6000mAh battery. The Champion WBook has the worst battery life of the lot 1 hour and 13 minutes, and not surprising since it has the smallest battery among all the rivals 2,200 mAh.

The battery test does throw up some damning statistics. The netbooks may claim that the tiny size, lesser power consumption and the smaller display helps them offer better battery life than the notebooks. However, the truth is that most laptops offer this much battery life, and then some. Not that big a selling point eh?

The Winners

It was a pretty close run thing, at the end of it all. The scores



HP Mini 210

were neck and neck, and on paper, it looked like no single netbook has a clear advantage over the rivals. In terms of performance, the Acer Aspire One 522 finished ahead of the Asus Eee PC 1015PW, but just about. The better battery life offered by the Aspire One helped it take the top step. When we looks at features individually, the Asus 1015PW was the clear winner, thanks to the combination of a very high capacity battery (at least on paper) and a weight of just above 1kg.



Acer Aspire One 522

When it came to rating the good looks, it really wasn't a surprise that the Asus Eee PC 1008P Karim Rashid edition was the winner, with the HP Mini in second place.

However, we believe that the Acer Aspire One 522 offers the best performance and best value for money, while the HP Mini 110 is definitely worth a consider, if you are out to buy a netbook. 



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